

WESTconsin Credit Union

Card servicing across three processors — one member question, three systems of record

A member asking why their card declined is asking one question. The answer sits across a card processor, a network switch and the core — none of which agrees with the others about what a transaction is called or when it happened.

3

processors behind
one question

1

servicing view
assembled

~\$2.2B

assets

~127K

members

1939

chartered

5

months, scoped
and delivered

INSTITUTION CONTEXT · PUBLICLY REPORTED

Menomonie, Wisconsin · roughly \$2.2bn in assets and about 127,000 members · a 28-county footprint across west-central Wisconsin and east-central Minnesota

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Vendor, processor and platform names removed. Institutional figures are publicly reported; the integration analysis is from the delivery record.

Three processors, three vocabularies, three clocks — and a member who expects one answer from whoever picks up the phone

Situation

A community credit union of roughly \$2.2 billion in assets serving about 127,000 members. Card servicing spans a card processing platform, a shared network and switch relationship, and the core banking system holding the underlying account.

Each is a legitimate system of record for a different part of the same event.

Complication

A staff member answering a card query has to consult all three, mentally reconcile three vocabularies and three timestamps, and translate the result into an answer.

That is slow, it is inconsistent between staff, and it produces the specific failure where two members with identical situations receive different explanations — which is worse than either explanation alone.

What was built

A single card servicing view that assembles the three sources into one timeline, in one vocabulary, with the authority for each fact visible.

And a dashboard layer over it, so the institution could see card servicing volume and causes rather than only individual cases.

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

3

sources, one timeline

1

vocabulary presented

1

authority per fact

0

reconciliation by staff

5

months end to end

1

dashboard over the whole

The principle applied: where several systems each own part of one event, the servicing layer's job is to assemble and attribute — never to adjudicate. It shows what each source says and which one is authoritative for that fact, rather than producing a merged answer that no source would confirm.

Institutional scale is publicly reported; the integration design and the servicing model come from the delivery record

PUBLICLY REPORTED Institution context Scale and footprint figures from public credit union reporting. • ~\$2.2bn total assets • ~127,000 members • Chartered 1939, Menomonie, Wisconsin • 28-county footprint, two states • Roughly eighteen branch locations • Community and agricultural membership	DELIVERY RECORD My ownership Card servicing integration and dashboard delivery during the 2025 engagement. • Three-source assembly design • Vocabulary and timeline normalisation • Authority-per-fact model • Card servicing view • Dashboard layer • Requirement through production	METHOD ILLUSTRATION Reconstructed The design detail shown illustrates the approach taken. Specific definitions, categories and figures are reconstructed for presentation and are not quoted from the programme record. • Approach is from the engagement • Detail is reconstructed to illustrate it • Figures are directional, never measured • Confirm specifics before citing them • The method is what transfers • Ask me for the underlying record	OUT OF SCOPE Not claimed Excluded deliberately. • Any member, card or transaction data • Any processor's internal behaviour • Institution financial outcomes • Any confidential document • Dispute or fraud outcomes • Commercial terms of engagement
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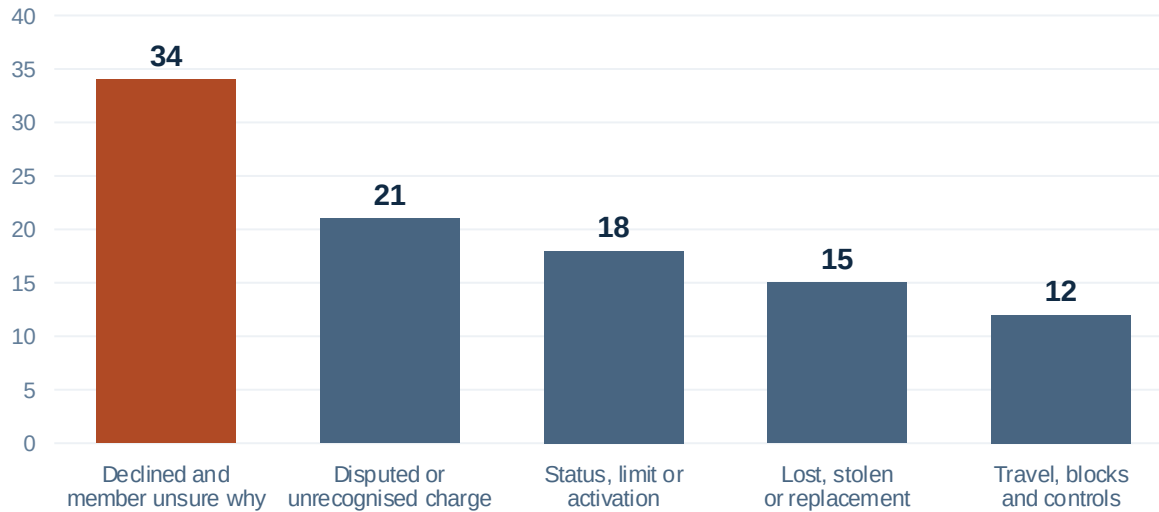
THE THREE SOURCES

Each source is authoritative for something different — and none of them is authoritative for the member's actual question

Source	Authoritative for	Not authoritative for	Clock
Card processing platform	The authorisation decision, the reason code, card status and limits	Whether funds were actually available in the account	Real time
Network and switch	Whether the transaction reached the processor at all, and routing	Why a decision was made once it arrived	Real time
Core banking system	The account balance, holds, and whether the posting settled	Anything about the card decision itself	Batch and real time mixed
The member's question	Nothing — it spans all three	—	Now

Why staff could not do this reliably	What the view had to do	Why attribution matters here
- Three interfaces, three logins, three vocabularies for the same event. - Timestamps that differ by clock and by convention, so ordering the sequence requires knowing which is which. - The reconciliation is done from memory, so two staff members produce two answers to the same question.	- Assemble the three into one chronological timeline with a single vocabulary. - Attribute every fact to its source, so the staff member can see where each element came from. - Never merge conflicting facts into a synthesised answer — show both and mark which source owns that fact.	- A card decline explanation can end up in a dispute, so the basis has to be traceable. - Sources genuinely disagree sometimes, usually on timing, and hiding that produces confident wrong answers. - Showing the authority also teaches staff the model, which reduces escalation over time.

The servicing view answers one member's question; the dashboard answers whether the institution has a card problem at all



Illustrative card query mix — the largest category is also the one needing all three sources

Why the two halves had to ship together

The servicing view without the dashboard makes individual conversations better and tells the institution nothing about whether the underlying volume is avoidable. The dashboard without the servicing view produces a chart of a problem nobody can act on in the moment.

Together they close a loop: a staff member answers the member using assembled facts, the disposition is captured once from that same view, and the aggregate then shows which decline reasons or control settings are generating the contact in the first place. Several of the largest categories in a card query mix are usually self-inflicted — a control set too tightly, an unclear notification — and they are only visible once the individual answers are being captured consistently.

What the dashboard made visible

- Query volume by cause rather than by channel, which is the cut that suggests a fix.
- Decline reasons in aggregate — where a control setting is generating avoidable member contact.
- Whether a spike is a member-behaviour change, a processor change or something the institution did.
- Which queries resolve at first contact now that all three sources are in one place.

Four rules for servicing across several systems of record

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|----|--|---|
| 01 | Assemble and attribute, never adjudicate | Where several systems each own part of one event, show what each says and which is authoritative for that fact. A merged answer that no source would confirm is worse than showing the disagreement. |
| 02 | Normalise the vocabulary and the clock | Most of the difficulty is not data access — it is that three systems name the same event differently and timestamp it on different conventions. Ordering the sequence correctly is the actual engineering. |
| 03 | Ship the aggregate with the individual view | Answering one member better is worth little if the institution cannot see which causes generate the volume. The disposition captured in the servicing view is what makes the aggregate real. |
| 04 | Expect the largest cause to be self-inflicted | In servicing mixes of this kind, the biggest category is usually a control set too tightly or a notification that does not explain itself. It only becomes visible once individual answers are captured consistently. |

The member asked one question. Answering it required three systems, three vocabularies and three clocks — and the institution could not see how often that was happening until the answering itself was made consistent.